

Sandra, it recommended upgrading the BIOS. How do I do that? From where do I get the BIOS that supports my motherboard?

Kamlesh Maru
Via e-mail

A Flashing the BIOS is not recommended unless absolutely necessary, since an error while flashing may make the motherboard unusable. If your PC is working fine, there's no need to 'fix' it. To learn how to flash your BIOS, refer to 'Flash Forward' in the June issue of Digit.

Slow data copy speeds

Q. I have recently purchased a 24x CD-Writer. I have a 52x CD-ROM drive and there is a huge difference in the copy speeds of my CD-Writer and CD-ROM drive. When I copy a 650 MB VCD from my CD-Writer, it takes 8-10 minutes. However, when I copy the VCD from my CD-ROM drive, it takes a whopping 25 to 30 minutes. What causes this difference in speeds? After all, my CD-ROM drive is not much older.

Amit Mehta
Via e-mail

A The difference in copying speeds could be because your CD-Writer is functioning at a higher transfer mode

(UDMA 2 or 4, depending on the CD-Writer), while your CD-ROM drive is functioning in PIO mode.

Ensure that the Ultra DMA modes for each drive are set to Auto in the Integrated Peripherals section of the BIOS. You can access the BIOS by pressing [Delete] when you get the Power-on Self Test screen during boot-up. Now restart the PC and enable DMA. For this, press [Windows] + [Pause Break] to launch System Properties. In the 'Device Manager' tab, click on the + sign next to CD-ROM and select the CD-ROM device installed on your PC. Then click on **Properties > Settings** and click on 'DMA'. This will result in a considerable increase in CD-ROM access and copying speeds.

Linux and NTFS

Q. I have a Compaq PC with a 1.5 GHz Pentium 4 processor, 256 MB RAM, and a 40 GB hard disk. My hard disk has two partitions: 34.5 GB, with NTFS file system and 2.72 GB with FAT32 file system.

These partitions came with the system with Windows XP Home Edition preinstalled by Compaq. Can I also install Linux on the above mentioned file systems or will I have to create a separate partition? Also, can Linux access the documents on Windows XP?

Ladoo
Via e-mail

A You will have to create a separate partition for Linux. The kernel shipped with most Linux flavours is not compiled with NTFS file system support.

So first you will have to compile the latest kernel with NTFS (Read Only) support because NTFS write is dangerous and is still in the experimental stage. Next, mount the NTFS partition in Linux.

You will now be able to access the files in the NTFS partition. If you want Read Only access to the Linux partition from your Windows partition, you will need a utility called *explore2fs*, which can be downloaded from uranus.it.swin.edu.au/~jn/linux/Explore2fs.htm.

Error starting HTML documents

Q. I use Windows Me on my Pentium III machine, which has 128 MB RAM. Whenever I try to start MS FrontPage or any HTML document in Windows, I get the following error message: 'The MSVCRT.DLL file is linked to missing export MSVCRT.dll:??_U@YAPAXI@Z'. What should I do to get rid of this message and start my HTML files and FrontPage? I also have to use a function called TweakUI from the Control Panel for extra settings and I usually play games.

Amit K.
Via e-mail

A This behaviour may occur after you install a program that overwrites either the *Msvcrt.dll* or the *Msvcrtdll* Windows system files with an incorrect or previous version, or if one of these two files is damaged or missing.

To rectify the problem, you can navigate to **Start > Program Files > Accessories > System Tools > System Information** and click on 'System File Checker' under the 'Tools' menu. Alternately, you can also type *SFC* in **Start > Run** to get to System File Checker directly. Once there, select the 'Extract one file from install disk' field to extract a file from your Windows Me CD. Specify the name of the file (*Msvcrt.dll*) and click 'Start'.

If you have an original equipment manufacturer (OEM) installation of Windows Me, the Windows installation files may be

stored in *C:\Windows\Options\Install*. In the 'Save File' box, type *C:*, and then click 'OK'. You will receive the following message: 'Extract File. The destination folder *C:* does not exist. Do you want to create it?' Click 'Yes', and then click 'OK'. Repeat the above steps for *Msvcrt.dll*.

Insert your Windows Me Startup disk, restart the computer, and then select **Minimal Boot** on the Microsoft Windows Millennium Startup Menu that appears.

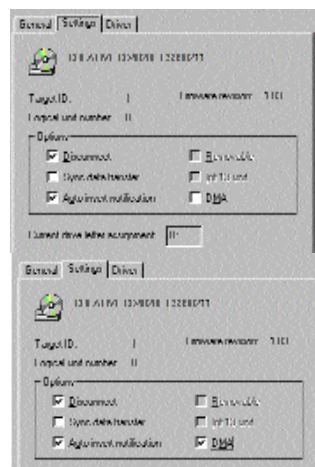
At the command prompt, type **Ren**
C:\Windows\System\Msvcrt.dll Msvcrt.old, and press [Enter]. Type **Ren**
C:\Windows\System\Msvcrtdll Msvcrtdll.old, and press [Enter]. Type **Copy C:\Msvcrt.dll C:\Windows\System**, and then press [Enter]. Type **Copy C:\Msvcrtdll C:\Windows\System**, and then press [Enter].

Remove the Windows Me Startup disk, and restart the computer.

Problem accessing Linux

Q. I have two PCs: one is a Pentium III 933 MHz machine, using a Gigabyte motherboard, and the other is a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz machine, using an Intel D845WN motherboard. Both machines have a 40 GB hard disk, and 128 MB SDRAM.

The P-III machine has four partitions; one each for Windows 98, Windows 2000, Windows XP and Red Hat Linux 7.0. In this machine the Linux Loader (LILO) is seen on booting the machine, i.e. during bootup, you are prompted to choose between Linux and Windows and if you choose Windows, then to choose between Windows 98, Windows 2000 and Windows XP. The Pentium 4 machine has six partitions plus a Linux partition. It has two operating systems: Windows 98 and Windows XP. But on installing Linux, LILO



Enabling DMA for faster data access